Earth and Planets · TA Brief

Learning goal: I can describe the Sun, Earth, and Moon as spheres and explain what orbits what in our solar system.

Watch (staff preview first)

Short silent teacher demonstration clip for this lesson's model and practical sequence · preview before class use.

Adult Support Routine

No cold calling; nobody is asked to read difficult text aloud.

Give time to start -> point to the relevant place -> rephrase -> offer a small prompt or word bank -> reduce to a limited choice.

Beside the You do in the pupil book, mark I (independent), S (supported) or C (choice).

Must-Know Words

sphere: a round 3D ball shape, like the Sun, Earth, and Moon

orbit: the curved path one object in space takes around another because of gravity

solar system: the Sun and the eight planets (plus moons and rocks) that orbit it

star: a giant ball of hot glowing gas that makes its own light, like our Sun

Key Answers

A. The Sun's gravitational pull holds the moving planets in elliptical (nearly circular) orbits.

A. Earth is a planet orbiting the Sun; the Moon is a natural satellite orbiting the Earth.

1. Approximately spherical (sphere). 2. Mercury, Venus, Earth, Mars. 3. The Earth orbits the Sun (in 1 year / 365 days), and the Moon orbits the Earth (in about 28 days).